PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #37 · DEPRESSION

“Nobody could possibly like me.”

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Where it often comes from

Rejection, teasing, betrayal, or the sense of being odd can harden into a rule: if people really knew me, liking me would be impossible. Depression makes that rule feel obvious. It confuses “some people have not liked me” with “no one could.” It also forgets that being liked is not the same thing as being loved by God, who already knows you and has not turned away.

What Scripture teaches

God’s love is not a guess about whether people find us pleasant. “While we were still sinners, Christ died for us.” Jesus tells His friends to remain in His love, the same love the Father has for Him. The Lord is among His people and quiets them with His love. He cares for you. People are free to like or not like, and their opinions are not a law. The lie says liking you is impossible. Scripture says you are already loved.

> *“But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us”* (Romans 5:8).

Also see

> “As the Father has loved Me, so have I loved you. Remain in My love” (John 15:9).

> “The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing” (Zephaniah 3:17).

> “Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you” (1 Peter 5:7).

> “‘Can a woman forget her nursing child, or lack compassion for the son of her womb? Even if she could forget, I will not forget you! Behold, I have inscribed you on the palms of My hands; your walls are ever before Me.’” (Isaiah 49:15–16).

Common self-statements

- If they knew the real me, they would leave.
- I am too much, or not enough, for anyone to enjoy.
- People are only being polite.
- I should stay quiet so no one has a reason to dislike me.
- Love is for other personalities.
- Even God merely puts up with me.

Common logical errors

- Mind reading: Knowing in advance that everyone would reject me.
- Overgeneralization: Turning some rejection into “nobody could like me.”
- Labeling: Treating my personality as something impossible to love.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unlikable and calling the feeling a fact about everyone.

Challenging questions

- Who has liked me, even a little, when they knew something true about me?

- Am I asking people to like a performance, or letting them know me?
- What am I sure they would hate, and is that the whole of me?
- Would I tell a quiet or awkward friend that nobody could like them?
- How is God's love different from being popular?
- What is one safe relationship where I could be a little more honest?

Truth summary

> Not everyone will like me, and that is not the same as nobody could. God loves me, and there are people who can know me and stay.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

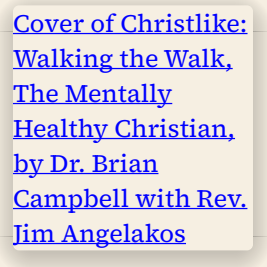
- Love, By God
- Friendship
- Loneliness
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Church

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Depression

What does a mentally healthy Christian look like?



From *Christlike: Walking the Walk* by Dr. Brian Campbell. A portrait, verse by verse, of how a mentally healthy Christian thinks, feels, and lives.

Read excerpts from "The Mentally Healthy Christian" (with every Scripture written out)

Listen: Overcoming Depression

Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome people, not to leave them unknown.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus knows suffering and still invites you to come.

Love Take Me Over — Steven Curtis Chapman
Receiving God's love can loosen the fear of being disliked.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
You can bring the fear of people to the Friend who carries burdens.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, what is one step I could take today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Nobody could possibly like me."

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Nobody could possibly like me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who has liked me, even a little, when they knew something true about me?
- ☐ Am I asking people to like a performance, or letting them know me?
- ☐ What am I sure they would hate, and is that the whole of me?
- ☐ Would I tell a quiet or awkward friend that nobody could like them?
- ☐ How is God's love different from being popular?
- ☐ What is one safe relationship where I could be a little more honest?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Not everyone will like me, and that is not the same as nobody could. God loves me, and there are people who can know me and stay.
- ☐ God loves me and already knows me.
- ☐ Some rejection is not universal rejection.
- ☐ I can be known a little more and still be liked.
- ☐ Being liked is pleasant. Being loved by God is certain.
- ☐ I do not have to perform to be worth knowing.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Romans 5:8
  "But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us."
- ☐ John 15:9
  "As the Father has loved Me, so have I loved you. Remain in My love."
- ☐ Zephaniah 3:17
  "The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When the "nobody could like me" feeling came: Each day, write down one moment when being known felt dangerous. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 5:8 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Christ loved me before I was impressive. Somebody already does.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Friendship" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio or the Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Stay for one real conversation. With a safe person, share one honest thing you usually hide. Notice whether they leave.
- [ ] Count the exceptions. Write the names of people who have enjoyed you. The word "nobody" has to survive that list.
- [ ] Receive a compliment without arguing. When someone says something kind, say "thank you" and write it down.
- [ ] Pray John 15:9 each morning: ask to remain in the love you did not earn.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Nobody could possibly like me.": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment I was liked or loved
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Nobody could possibly like me~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I expect dislike before anyone has a chance to know me. Root me in Your love, and help me risk being known by one safe person. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.